

Planning
Culminating Writing Project
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Hints

- The **Hints** section provides general descriptions of scenes related to each row’s focus, such as *Dream Benefits* or *Dream Detriments*. Each hint gives you a scene's location within a specific section/chapter of *Of Mice and Men*, not by page number. This means you’ll need to read through the section to locate the scene and understand how it might connect to the claim in that row.
1. Locate the Scene
 - a. Use the section number in each hint to find the scene in the book. You may need to reread parts of the section to ensure you’ve found the right part.
 2. Consider Inference and Indirect Evidence
 - a. Not every hint will have a single quote that directly connects to the claim. Sometimes, the evidence may be indirect, meaning you’ll need to infer the connection or consider how the scene contributes to a character’s dream, challenges, or relationships over time. Think about the characters’ actions, words, or even silences in the scene, and how these might relate to the claim.
 3. Analyze Themes That Develop Over Time
 - a. Some hints refer to ideas or struggles that build up throughout the story. A character’s dream or barrier might be impacted gradually, so pay attention to repeated themes or patterns that show up in different scenes. For example, Slim’s respectfulness is shown subtly and might require looking at multiple interactions to understand his impact on others.
 4. Develop Your Own Analysis
 - a. Once you have identified the connection, think of your own way to explain it. Avoid copying explanations or interpretations directly; instead, develop an original analysis that demonstrates your understanding. This will help you create a unique response that is based on your personal reading of the text.
 5. Supporting Claims with Evidence
 - a. Use the hint’s scene as evidence for your claim in that row. This will be the basis for your paragraph, supporting how a particular scene or character interaction relates to the character’s dream, its impact on them, or the obstacles they face.

There are hints for each recommended character.

Use this for the hints. You do not have to complete it separately.

Selected Character:	George	
Character's Dream:		See Sections 1 and 3.
Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 1: George and Lennie discuss their shared dream while camping. • Section 2: George explains the dream to Slim. • Section 3: George feels hopeful when Candy expresses interest in joining. • Section 4: George describes the details of the dream to calm Lennie. • Section 1: Lennie's excitement about tending rabbits. • Section 3: George talks with Candy about saving money. • Section 1: George and Lennie reflect on the dream while resting.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	• Section 1: Lennie eagerly listens as George describes their future farm. • Section 3: Candy offers his savings. • Section 2: Slim's compassionate response to George's dream.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	• Section 4: Curley's wife's interactions with Lennie. • Section 3: Carlson's cold, practical attitude. • Section 2: Curley's hostility toward George and Lennie.
Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 1: George tells Lennie about past troubles they've faced together. • Section 4: George urges Lennie to avoid trouble with Curley's wife. • Section 3: George confides in Slim about the difficulties of looking

Achieving—the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):		after Lennie. - Section 5: George seems burdened by managing Lennie’s behavior. - Section 1: George tells Lennie they can’t talk about their dream to others. - Section 4: George grows uneasy when Lennie interacts with Curley’s wife. - Section 5: George realizes the danger of the dream after Lennie’s incident.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 2: Slim offers understanding to George. - Section 3: Candy’s willingness to join. - Section 1: Lennie’s excitement about the dream.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 4: Curley’s wife’s flirtatious behavior with Lennie. - Section 2: The Boss’s suspicious attitude.
Barriers List (Challenges Arising that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):		- Section 3: Lennie accidentally kills a puppy. - Section 4: Curley’s wife’s interactions with Lennie. - Section 2: Curley’s aggressive attitude toward Lennie. - Section 5: George feels the burden of managing Lennie’s mistakes. - Section 1: George explains the difficulty of saving money as a ranch worker. - Section 3: George and Candy calculate how much they’ll need. - Section 2: George reflects on how many other men have similar

		dreams that never come true. • Section 3: George feels torn when Candy offers money.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:	• •	• Section 3: Candy’s financial contribution. • Section 5: Slim supports George after a major setback. • Section 1: Lennie’s belief in the dream.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:	• •	• Section 2: Curley’s aggression creates constant tension. • Section 4: Her interactions with Lennie. • Section 5: Carlson’s practical but detached attitude.

Selected Character:	Lennie	
Character's Dream:		See Sections 1 and 3.
Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 1: Lennie eagerly listens as George describes their dream. • Section 2: Lennie asks George to repeat the part about the rabbits. • Section 3: Lennie feels comforted while hearing about the dream. • Section 1: Lennie is reassured when George talks about their future farm. • Section 1: Lennie tells George he'll work hard for the dream. • Section 1: Lennie smiles at the thought of tending rabbits. • Section 3: Lennie proudly discusses their plan with Candy.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	• Section 1: George describes their dream to Lennie. • Section 3: Candy expresses interest in joining their dream. • Section 4: Lennie's memory of Aunt Clara gives him a sense of comfort and a reminder of a better life.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	• Section 2: Curley's aggression toward Lennie. • Section 4: Her flirtation with Lennie leads him into trouble. • Section 3: Carlson's dismissive attitude about ranch life.
Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 1: Lennie worries he'll mess things up. • Section 2: Lennie accidentally hurts small animals. • Section 4: Lennie fears George won't let him tend rabbits if he causes trouble. • Section 5: Lennie's regret after the incident with Curley's wife.

Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):		- Section 1: Lennie needs constant reassurance about their future. - Section 3: Lennie gets frustrated by his own limitations. - Section 4: Lennie's misunderstanding with Curley's wife leads to unintended consequences.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 1: George's reassurance about their future farm. - Section 3: Candy's enthusiasm about joining their dream. - Section 2: Slim's kindness toward Lennie.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 4: Curley's wife's interaction with Lennie. - Section 2: Curley's antagonistic behavior intimidates Lennie. - Section 2: The Boss's distrust of George and Lennie.
Barriers List (Challenges Arising that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):		- Section 3: Lennie's struggle to control his strength. - Section 4: Curley's hostility toward Lennie. - Section 1: Lennie forgets instructions, showing his challenges in following the plan. - Section 5: Lennie's interaction with Curley's wife. - Section 1: Lennie accidentally kills a mouse. - Section 2: Lennie's fear of disappointing George. - Section 4: Lennie's inability to understand social boundaries. - Section 5: Lennie's actions leading up to his hiding.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help		- Section 1: George's instructions and support guide Lennie, helping him manage his behavior. - Section 3: Candy's promise to contribute financially.

in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:		Section 2: Slim’s kindness helps Lennie.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:		Section 2: Curley’s hostility and threats to Lennie. Section 4: Her interactions with Lennie distract him and set the stage for significant trouble. Section 3: Carlson’s disregard for Lennie’s feelings.

Selected Character:	Candy	
Character's Dream:		See Section 3.
Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 3: Candy first hears about George and Lennie's plan and expresses interest. • Section 3: Candy offers his savings to join the dream. • Section 3: Candy talks about his fears of being let go from the ranch. • Section 3: Candy's mood lifts when George agrees to let him join. • Section 3: Candy describes his excitement about their future to George. • Section 3: Candy talks about the farm's specific features with George and Lennie. • Section 3: Candy explains his relief at having a future plan. • Section 3: Candy's confidence grows as he discusses their goal.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	• Section 3: George agrees to let Candy join the dream, giving him new hope. • Section 3: Lennie's excitement about the dream. • Section 3: Slim listens to Candy's hopes.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	• Section 4: Curley's constant tension on the ranch. • Section 5: Her interactions with Lennie and George. • Section 3: Carlson's practical but dismissive view of Candy's dreams.
Dream Detriments List	1. - a.	• Section 3: Candy expresses frustration over feeling powerless on the ranch.

(How Having—not Necessarily Achieving—the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):	2. a.	- Section 5: Candy is devastated when the plan with George and Lennie falls apart. - Section 5: Candy’s frustration surfaces as he reflects on losing the chance to leave the ranch. - Section 3: Candy’s regret over his aging and physical limitations. - Section 3: Candy worries about the risk of the dream not coming true. - Section 4: Candy’s caution around Curley’s wife, fearing conflict. - Section 5: Candy’s disappointment after Lennie’s incident.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 3: George’s willingness to include Candy. - Section 4: Slim shows understanding toward Candy’s regrets. - Section 3: Lennie’s enthusiasm about the future.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:		- Section 3: Curley’s aggressive attitude. - Section 2: The Boss’s disregard for Candy’s age and injury heightens his sense of insecurity. - Section 5: Her actions cause further trouble.
Barriers List (Challenges Arising that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):	1. a. 2. a.	- Section 3: Candy realizes his limited financial power compared to others on the ranch. - Section 3: Candy talks about his age and physical limitations. - Section 4: Candy’s interaction with Curley’s wife highlights his cautious nature. - Section 5: Candy feels the dream slipping away after Lennie’s incident. - Section 3: Candy’s dependence on George and Lennie to fulfill the

		dream. • Section 3: Candy feels vulnerable about needing a future plan. • Section 5: Candy's disappointment after realizing they may not reach the dream.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:	• •	• Section 3: George's acceptance of Candy's financial offer. • Section 3: Lennie's support and belief in the plan. • Section 2: Slim's quiet support.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:	• •	• Section 2: Curley's hostility and threats. • Section 4: Her presence and interactions with Lennie. • Section 3: Carlson's detachment and indifference.

Selected Character:	Curley's wife	
Character's Dream:		See Section 4.
Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 4: Curley's wife talks about her past dreams with Lennie. • Section 4: Curley's wife reflects on her missed opportunities to be in movies. • Section 4: Curley's wife imagines a life beyond the ranch. • Section 4: Curley's wife expresses pride in the attention she once received. • Section 4: Curley's wife shares her belief that she could have been famous. • Section 4: Curley's wife describes the hope she had before marrying Curley. • Section 4: Curley's wife mentions the promise someone made to get her into Hollywood. • Section 4: Curley's wife explains how her dream made her feel special.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	• Section 4: Lennie listens to Curley's Wife's story about her dreams. • Section 4: Curley's Wife recalls her mother's past support.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	• Section 4: Curley's controlling behavior. • Section 4: George shows little sympathy for Curley's wife's dreams. • Section 2: The Boss's dismissive attitude as Curley's father.

Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i>—the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	• Section 4: Curley’s wife expresses frustration about being stuck on the ranch. • Section 4: Curley’s wife complains about Curley’s lack of understanding. • Section 5: Curley’s wife feels isolated, with no one to talk to. • Section 4: Curley’s wife’s bitterness about her unfulfilled dreams surfaces in her conversations. • Section 4: Curley’s wife feels trapped in her life choices and regrets them. • Section 4: Curley’s wife reveals anger over how her life turned out. • Section 4: Curley’s wife resents not being able to pursue her goals. • Section 5: Curley’s wife’s loneliness leads her to seek attention from others on the ranch.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:	• •	• Section 4: Lennie’s willingness to listen. • Section 4: Slim’s respectful demeanor makes Curley’s Wife feel seen, if only for a brief moment.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:	• •	• Section 4: Curley’s possessiveness and neglect. • Section 4: George’s distrust and avoidance. • Section 3: The workers’ dismissive and wary attitude.
Barriers List (Challenges Arising	1. - a.	• Section 2: Curley’s wife faces judgment and rejection from the ranch workers.

that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):	2. a.	- Section 4: Curley's wife feels limited by Curley's possessive behavior. - Section 4: Curley's wife reveals her frustration with being unable to leave the ranch. - Section 5: Curley's wife's need for companionship clashes with the ranch's social rules. - Section 4: Curley's wife's interactions with Lennie and Candy show her struggle for acceptance. - Section 4: Curley's wife faces resentment from the men who view her as a troublemaker. - Section 4: Curley's wife tries to connect with Lennie but faces misunderstandings. - Section 4: Curley's wife's attempts to talk about her dreams are dismissed by the others.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:		- Section 4: Lennie's attention. - Section 3: Slim's respectful treatment.
Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:		- Section 4: Curley's possessive behavior. - Section 2: The workers' mistrust and avoidance. - Section 4: George's refusal to engage with her.

Glossary

Analyze: Look at something closely to understand it better; break down into parts to understand.
Barrier: An obstacle or something that gets in the way; something that makes it hard to achieve a goal.
Benefit: A good thing; something that helps or is useful.
Burden: A heavy responsibility or a difficult duty; something that weighs you down.
Commitment: A promise or strong dedication to something; something you are determined to do.
Conflict: A problem or struggle; when two people or things don't agree.
Creates Conflict: Causes a problem or disagreement.
Detriment: A harm or negative effect; something that hurts or makes things worse.
Dream (in this context): A goal or hope for the future; something you really want.
Economic Challenges: Money problems; struggles related to earning, saving, or spending money.
Example: A model or sample; something used to show or explain an idea.
Explanation: An answer that makes something clearer; saying why or how something happens.
Goal: A purpose or something you want to achieve.
Guide: To lead or help; something that shows the way.
Impact: The effect or result of something; how something changes things.
Influence: The power to change or affect something or someone.
Interpretation: Your understanding or way of explaining something.
Mitigate: To make something less bad; reduce the harm.
Motivate: To make someone want to do something; encourage.
Obstacle: Something that gets in the way; a problem or challenge.
Organize: Arrange or put in order; make clear and neat.
Permanently: Forever; something that doesn't change back.
Pursue: To try to get or achieve; to follow a goal.
Purpose: Reason for doing something; goal.
Realistic: Something true to life; believable or sensible.
Reflect: To show something or think about it deeply; to represent.
Reinforce: To make stronger; support.
Relationship: A connection or bond between people.
Remind: To make someone remember something.
Responsibility: A duty or job; something you're supposed to do.
Result: The outcome or effect; what happens because of something.

Risk: The chance of something bad happening; danger.
Setback: A delay or something that slows progress; a problem.
Situation: The way things are; the setting or condition.
Stable: Steady and secure; safe and unchanging.
Structure: The way something is organized or put together.
Support: To help or back up.
Threatens: To say or act like you will harm someone; to make someone feel unsafe.
Topic: The main subject or idea.
Unique: Different from all others; special or one of a kind.